

CEO

Vivian Stroud, Syndicate Chair

CEO · EXECUTIVE



HIRE

◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Specialty funding source.

Your target-opponent Surprise Inspections cost 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to stop a Litigation Stress Test that hits you.

Will write the risk nobody else will touch, at a price nobody else would charge.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 203 / 373

London

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 4 branch only

Liquidity

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 3 Specialty funding sources you control, rounded down.

The first Treaty or Cover you play on your turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

There is a market for that, and it meets at lunch.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 350 / 373

Excess & Surplus Lines

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Litigation ▲ Regulation ▲ Liquidity ▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Fireworks factories, haunted houses, and anything else the standard market declined.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 025 / 373

Excess & Surplus Lines

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Litigation ▲ Regulation ▲ Liquidity ▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Fireworks factories, haunted houses, and anything else the standard market declined.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 025 / 373

Excess & Surplus Lines

SPECIALTY



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◆ 1 Leverage a turn

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Fireworks factories, haunted houses, and anything else the standard market declined.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 025 / 373

Excess & Surplus Lines

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

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▲ Litigation ▲ Regulation ▲ Liquidity ▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Fireworks factories, haunted houses, and anything else the standard market declined.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 025 / 373

Directors & Officers

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

Litigation ▲ Short-Term Equity

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

When the stock drops the lawsuits follow, and you insure the people being sued.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 028 / 373

Directors & Officers

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

Litigation ▲ Short-Term Equity

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

When the stock drops the lawsuits follow, and you insure the people being sued.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 028 / 373

Directors & Officers

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

Litigation ▲ Short-Term Equity

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

When the stock drops the lawsuits follow, and you insure the people being sued.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 028 / 373

FUNDING SOURCE

Captive Fronting Program

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1 run start

▲ Regulation

▲ Liquidity

▼ Low Interest Rates

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A borrowed license on the front, someone else's risk in the back, collateral in between.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 026 / 373

FUNDING SOURCE

Captive Fronting Program

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1 run start

▲ Regulation

▲ Liquidity

▼ Low Interest Rates

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A borrowed license on the front, someone else's risk in the back, collateral in between.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 026 / 373

FUNDING SOURCE

Assumed Reinsurance

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1 each turn

▲ Nat Cat: Any

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Insurance for insurance companies, because it's insurers all the way down.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 027 / 373

FUNDING SOURCE

Assumed Reinsurance

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

1 each turn

▲ Nat Cat: Any

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Insurance for insurance companies, because it's insurers all the way down.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 027 / 373

FUNDING SOURCE

Surety Bonds

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1 run start

▲ Inflation

▲ Short-Term Equity

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

You guarantee the contractor finishes the bridge, and the contractor guarantees nothing.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 029 / 373

FUNDING SOURCE

Surety Bonds

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1 run start

▲ Inflation

▲ Short-Term Equity

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

You guarantee the contractor finishes the bridge, and the contractor guarantees nothing.

S

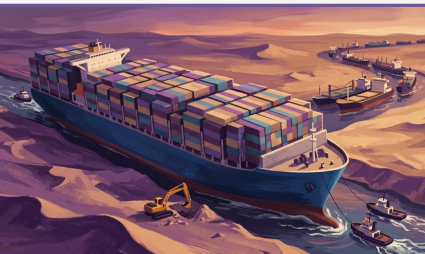
ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 029 / 373

FUNDING SOURCE

Marine Cargo

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1 run start

▲ Nat Cat: Flood

▲ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Twenty thousand containers, one narrow canal, and a ship that turned left.

S

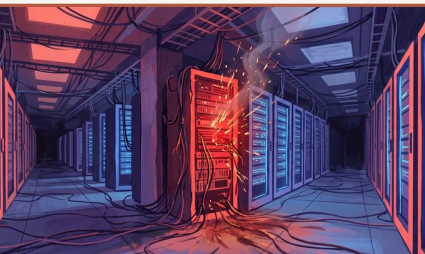
ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 030 / 373

FUNDING SOURCE

Cyber Liability

P&C · SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1 run start

▲ Cyber

▲ Litigation

▲ Regulation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

One bad software update, ten thousand claims by lunch.

P

S

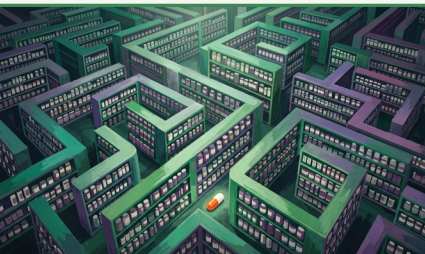
ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 023 / 373

FUNDING SOURCE

Pharmacy Benefit Management

HEALTH · SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1 run start

▲ Health Price

▲ Regulation

▲ Litigation

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

The formulary is a maze, and you own the walls.

H

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 017 / 373

INVESTMENT

INVESTMENT

Junk Bonds

INVESTMENT

COST
♦ 3

YIELD
● 2 each turn

SALE
2 any time

▲ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if Great Recession or Northern Rock Bank Run hits you.

Some people will lend money to anyone who promises to pay them back with interest. Some people are you.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 045 / 373

INVESTMENT

INVESTMENT

Litigation Finance

ILLIQUID

COST
♦ 2

YIELD
● 1 each turn

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation ▼ Litigation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Whenever a Litigation Stress Test resolves, gain 1 Surplus.

When claims severity rises, someone funds the lawsuit.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 064 / 373

RISK MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT

Committed Credit Line

TREATY

COST
♦ 2

Carrying Cost: 1 Surplus per Liquidity exposure you carry, including converted exposures. Pay it at the start of your turn or discard this.

Your Liquidity exposures don't count.

Any time: discard this to add 4 Leverage. At the start of your next turn, lose 2 Surplus.

The best time to ask for cash is before everyone else needs it.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 121 / 373

RISK MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT

Sign-On Bonus

RESPONSE

COST
♦ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Poach an opponent's employee. (Pay its Hire plus 2 Surplus. It gains Non-compete and arrives committed.)

The offer arrived the morning the crisis hit, when nobody likes their boss.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 162 / 373

RISK MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT

Exclusion Clause

RESPONSE

COST
♦ 2

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Prevent all loss to you from this Stress Test's largest clause.

Please see page 47, paragraph (c)(ii), which your customer did not read.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 131 / 373

RISK MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT

Exclusion Clause

RESPONSE

COST
♦ 2

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Prevent all loss to you from this Stress Test's largest clause.

Please see page 47, paragraph (c)(ii), which your customer did not read.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 131 / 373

TALENT

TALENT

Treasurer

RISK & COMPLIANCE

HIRE
♦ 2

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Liquidity clauses.

Knows where every dollar is at 4 p.m., and where it has to be by 9 a.m.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 207 / 373

SIGNATURE TOOL

SIGNATURE TOOL

Generative AI Pilot

SOFTWARE

PRICE
♦ 2

CARRYING COST
● 1 each turn

SIGNATURE AI

▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck; AI: AI Bubble Bursts destroys it.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Summarizes every report in the building, including three that don't exist.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 368 / 373

SIGNATURE TOOL

SIGNATURE TOOL

Mobile App

SOFTWARE

PRICE
♦ 3

SIGNATURE

▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.

You may add an additional funding source each turn.

Four and a half stars, two million downloads, and one intern who knows the admin password.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 363 / 373

Adverse Development Cover

TREATY



COST

♦ 2

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a P&C or Specialty funding source.

When Litigation clauses cost you Surplus, regain up to 6 of it. Then discard this.

Reinsurance for the claims you already have.



ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 137 / 373

Corporate Spy

FRONT LINE

DARK



HIRE

♦ 2

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Each opponent's maximum hand size is 1 lower.

Badge says Facilities, laptop says otherwise.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 214 / 373

Nuclear Verdict

LITIGATION



COST

♦ 4

HITS

Target opponent

▲ Litigation

Target opponent loses 6 Surplus per Litigation exposure and 1 per Dark card in their discard pile, plus 2 more.

The jury took forty minutes to reach a verdict that will take four years to appeal.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 270 / 373

Data Breach

CYBER



COST

♦ 4

HITS

Target opponent

▲ Cyber

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Cyber exposure and 1 per Dark card in their discard pile, plus 4 more. Then they discard a card.

The password was 'Password1', and the regulator's fine was somewhat harder to guess.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 277 / 373

Executive Scandal

REPUTATION



COST

♦ 5

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 1 Surplus per Dark card on their board and 1 per Dark card in their discard pile, plus 6 more. Then they have one employee or CEO to fire, chosen by the runner.

Leaked texts, a 6 a.m. board call, and a very generous severance.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 280 / 373

Smear Campaign

REPUTATION

DARK



COST

♦ 4

HITS

Each opponent

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Each opponent loses 3 Surplus. Then they can't add a funding source on their next turn.

Sources close to no one say your rivals are in trouble.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 296 / 373

Margin Call

LIQUIDITY



COST

♦ 4

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 2 per Volatility exposure, and 2 per investment they control.

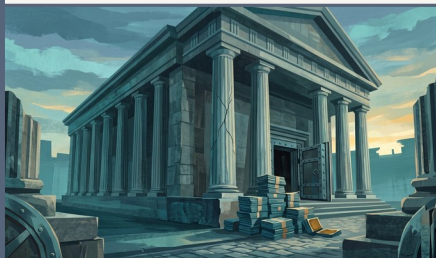
The broker would like a word, and also your cash.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 275 / 373

Long-Term Treasuries

INVESTMENT



COST

♦ 2

YIELD

♦ 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ Inflation ▼ Short-Term Equity

Destroyed if Debt Ceiling Breach hits you.

Typically boring, but caused the most recent bank run.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 051 / 373

Cat Bond - Nat Cat

INVESTMENT



COST

♦ 4

YIELD

♦ 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

Destroyed if a Nat Cat Stress Test hits you.

Betting against Mother Nature: the only casino where the house sometimes loses.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 049 / 373

SIGNATURE FUNDING SOURCE

Space & Satellite

SPECIALTY



CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

SIGNATURE

Cyber

Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Priced per launch, per orbit, and per whether the founder insists on riding along.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 041 / 373

SIGNATURE SURPRISE INSPECTION

Hackers' SEC Tip

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2023



COST

4

HITS

Target opponent

SIGNATURE

Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.

Target opponent loses 5 Surplus per Cyber exposure and 4 per Dark card in their discard pile. Then they have one Tool to discard, chosen by the runner.

In 2023 a ransomware gang reported the company it had hacked to the SEC, for failing to disclose the hack. Even the criminals had read the new disclosure rules.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 310 / 373

OFFICE LOCATION

Munich

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

4

branch only

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

Commit this office during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Nat Cat or Mortality clauses.

Has modeled the next hundred years and would prefer a quiet quarter.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 352 / 373

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

Loss Portfolio Transfer

TREATY



COST

0

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

While this is in play, 1 of your unhedged Litigation exposures counts as Credit instead. Each exposure can flip only once; earlier Risk Management cards choose first. If none remain, this does nothing.

The claims are gone, and in their place sits a counterparty.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 158 / 373

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Ransomware

CYBER



COST

1

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one Tool to discard, chosen by the runner.

The ransom note was polite, well formatted, and had a support line.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 337 / 373

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Asset Freeze

GEOPOLITICAL



COST

2

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent has one Investment to discard without Sale proceeds, chosen by the runner.

The position was marked at full value right up until the moment it could not be sold, moved, or mentioned.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 335 / 373

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Hurricane Andrew

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 1992



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Nat Cat: Flood

Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Nat Cat: Flood exposure and 4 per Property Value exposure.

In August 1992, Hurricane Andrew came ashore south of Miami with winds above 160 mph and destroyed or damaged more than 100,000 homes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 236 / 373

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

Basel III Endgame

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2023



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Regulation

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Regulation exposure, plus 5 more. Then each company discards a card.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Rated Feeder Note it controls.

In July 2023, U.S. regulators proposed the Basel III endgame, which would have raised big banks' capital requirements by about 16%.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 274 / 373

SIGNATURE STRESS TEST

1918 Influenza

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 1918



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Mortality

Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

The 1918 influenza pandemic swept the world in three waves and killed tens of millions of people, many of them young adults.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 240 / 373

Cancer Cured

LONGEVITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Longevity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 12 Surplus per Longevity exposure.

Champagne in the lab, followed by a very quiet meeting in annuity reserving.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 246 / 373

1906 San Francisco Earthquake

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 1906



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE**ACT OF GOD**

▲ Nat Cat: Earthquake

▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 12 Surplus per Nat Cat: Earthquake exposure and 4 per Property Value exposure.

Surprise trust fall.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 251 / 373

Quantitative Easing

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 2008



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE**ACT OF GOD**

▲ Low Interest Rates

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Low Interest Rates exposure.

In November 2008, the Federal Reserve began buying hundreds of billions of dollars of bonds to push long-term interest rates down. It was very clear about its plans, which was the problem.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 250 / 373

Bird Flu Pandemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE**ACT OF GOD**

▲ Mortality

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

Talk about a viral tweet!

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 241 / 373

Sinking of the Titanic

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 1912



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Mortality

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Mortality exposure, plus 2 more.

Rich people buy a ton of life insurance.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 263 / 373

Vietnam War

GEOPOLITICAL · AS-IF REPLAY, 1965



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Inflation

▲ Mortality

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Inflation exposure and 4 per Mortality exposure.

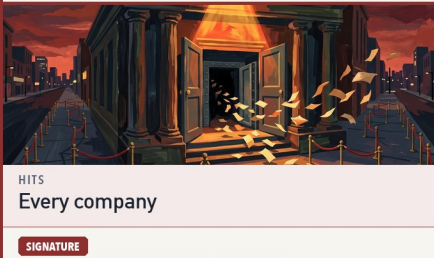
In 1965 the United States sent combat troops to Vietnam, starting a long war that cost millions of lives and helped push up inflation at home.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 262 / 373

Northern Rock Bank Run

LIQUIDITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2007



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Liquidity

▲ Short-Term Equity

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure. Then each company discards half its Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Junk Bonds, Private Credit Fund, or Feeder Fund it controls.

In September 2007, Northern Rock sought emergency support as wholesale funding dried up. Depositors queued outside its branches.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 268 / 373

Zero-Commission Price War

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2019



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 2 Surplus. Then each company commits 2 of its available funding sources.

On October 1, 2019, Charles Schwab cut its online stock trading commissions to zero, and its biggest rivals matched within days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 286 / 373

2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2003



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE**ACT OF GOD**

▲ Mortality

▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 233 / 373

AWS S3 Outage

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE
▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.
Every company loses 6 Surplus per Cyber exposure, plus 3 more. Then each company discards a card.
On February 28, 2017, a mistyped command knocked Amazon's S3 storage offline for about four hours, and Amazon's status page could not show it, because it ran on S3.

Iowa Derecho

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD
▲ Nat Cat

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.
Every company loses 2 Surplus per Nat Cat exposure.
On August 10, 2020, a derecho crossed Iowa with winds up to 140 mph, flattening corn, grain bins, and most of the trees in Cedar Rapids.

Cape Wind Abandoned

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE
▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.
Every company loses 10 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure.
In December 2017, after sixteen years of fights with its neighbors, the company behind Cape Wind, planned as America's first offshore wind farm, gave up. Nothing got built.

Klarna's Down Round

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS
Every company

SIGNATURE
▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.
Every company loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure.
In July 2022, Klarna, Europe's biggest buy now, pay later lender, raised money at a valuation 85% below its peak a year earlier. Four easy payments, then the fifth, the sixth, and the collections calls.